ENGLISH Mids MCQs

Types of Sentences & Tag Questions
Medium & Hard Level — With Answer Explanations

■ SECTION 1: TYPES OF SENTENCES (Q1–Q20)

■ Simple Sentence

Q1. Which of the following best describes a simple sentence? MEDIUM

A) A sentence with two independent clauses joined by a conjunction
✔ **B) A sentence with one independent clause that may include a subject, verb, and object**
C) A sentence with one independent clause and one dependent clause
D) A sentence that only contains a subject and a verb with no other elements

■ *Explanation: A simple sentence (also called an independent clause) conveys ONE main idea and consists of a subject, verb, descriptors, and sometimes an object. It does not require a second clause.*

Q2. In the sentence 'The accounting department will conduct a detailed audit,' which word functions as the OBJECT? MEDIUM

A) accounting department
B) will conduct
C) detailed
✔ **D) audit**

■ *Explanation: 'Audit' is the receiver of the action (object). 'Accounting department' is the subject, 'will conduct' is the verb, and 'detailed' is the adjective/descriptor.*

Q3. An independent clause is also referred to as a _____. MEDIUM

A) dependent clause
B) subordinate clause
✔ **C) simple sentence**
D) compound sentence

■ *Explanation: Per the terminology note in the slides: independent clause = simple sentence (stands alone). A dependent clause is also called a subordinate clause.*

Q4. Which sentence is a CORRECT example of a simple sentence with all four components (subject, verb, object, adjective)? HARD

A) Although costs were high, the board decided.
B) Sales were up and the staff will receive a bonus.
✔ **C) The marketing team launched a successful campaign.**
D) If profits rise, the firm will expand globally.

■ *Explanation: 'The marketing team launched a successful campaign' — subject: marketing team, verb: launched, object: campaign, adjective: successful. Options A and D are complex sentences; Option B is compound.*

Q5. A simple sentence can be extended with descriptors. Which pair correctly identifies descriptors? HARD

A) Subjects and verbs

✔ **B) Adverbs and adjectives**

C) Conjunctions and prepositions

D) Objects and complements

■ *Explanation: According to the material, descriptors include adverbs and adjectives. They add detail to the simple sentence without creating additional clauses.*

■ Compound Sentence

Q6. A compound sentence consists of: MEDIUM

A) One independent clause and one dependent clause

B) Two or more independent clauses and one dependent clause

✔ **C) Two independent but related clauses**

D) One main clause with multiple descriptors

■ *Explanation: The compound sentence joins TWO independent but related clauses, typically using coordinating conjunctions like 'and', 'but', 'or'.*

Q7. In the compound sentence 'Sales were up this year at the European office AND the marketing staff from that region will receive a bonus,' what is the role of 'and'? MEDIUM

A) It introduces a dependent clause

B) It is a subordinating conjunction linking unequal clauses

✔ **C) It is a coordinating conjunction joining two independent clauses**

D) It is an adverb modifying the verb

■ *Explanation: In compound sentences, coordinating conjunctions (and, but, or, so) join two INDEPENDENT clauses of equal rank. 'And' here connects two clauses that can each stand alone.*

Q8. Which of the following is a correctly formed compound sentence? MEDIUM

A) Although there was disagreement, a consensus was reached.

✔ **B) The main plant will be hiring this spring, but it is not yet known how many positions will be offered.**

C) Investment in foreign countries can be very profitable.

D) Even though the expansion needed to be initiated, the board decided.

■ *Explanation: Option B joins two independent clauses with 'but' — this is a compound sentence. Option A is complex (dependent clause first). Option C is simple. Option D is complex.*

Q9. What distinguishes a compound sentence from a compound-complex sentence? HARD

A) A compound sentence has a dependent clause; compound-complex does not

✔ **B) A compound sentence only has independent clauses; compound-complex also includes at least one dependent clause**

C) A compound sentence uses subordinating conjunctions; compound-complex uses coordinating conjunctions

D) There is no difference — they are the same structure

■ *Explanation: Compound = two or more independent clauses only. Compound-complex = two or more independent clauses PLUS at least one dependent clause. The presence of a dependent clause is the key difference.*

Q10. Identify the coordinating conjunction in: 'However, cost was not all that was standing in the way of a final decision AND the board knew this.' HARD

A) However

B) not

✔ **C) and**

D) all

■ *Explanation: 'And' is the coordinating conjunction joining the two independent clauses. 'However' is a conjunctive adverb (transitional word), not a coordinating conjunction — it cannot grammatically join two independent clauses the way 'and' does.*

■ Complex Sentence

Q11. A complex sentence consists of: MEDIUM

A) Two independent clauses joined by a conjunction

✔ **B) One independent clause and one or more dependent clauses**

C) Only one dependent clause with no independent clause

D) Two dependent clauses joined by a subordinating conjunction

■ *Explanation: A complex sentence = ONE independent clause + ONE or more dependent clauses. The dependent clause cannot stand alone and relies on the independent clause for meaning.*

Q12. In the sentence 'Although there was disagreement, a consensus was reached,' which is the dependent clause? MEDIUM

A) a consensus was reached

✔ **B) Although there was disagreement**

C) there was disagreement

D) a consensus

■ *Explanation: 'Although there was disagreement' is the dependent clause — it cannot stand alone as a complete sentence. It begins with 'although', a subordinating conjunction. 'A consensus was reached' is the independent clause.*

Q13. When a dependent clause appears FIRST in a complex sentence, it is usually followed by: MEDIUM

A) A semicolon

B) A colon

✔ **C) A comma**

D) No punctuation

■ *Explanation: Per the rule from the material: when a dependent clause appears first, it is usually followed by a comma before the independent clause. When the independent clause comes first, no comma is needed.*

Q14. Which sentence demonstrates a complex sentence where the independent clause comes FIRST (no comma needed)? HARD

A) Although it will be costly, expansion is necessary.

✔ **B) Investment in foreign countries can be very profitable even though there may be a margin of risk.**

C) Even though costs rose, the board proceeded.

D) Because the report was late, the meeting was cancelled.

■ *Explanation: In Option B, the independent clause ('Investment in foreign countries can be very profitable') comes first, followed by the dependent clause ('even though there may be a margin of risk') — no comma*

needed. Options A, C, and D all start with dependent clauses and need commas.

Q15. A dependent clause is also called a _____ clause. HARD

A) coordinate

B) independent

✔ **C) subordinate**

D) simple

■ *Explanation: Per the terminology note: dependent clause = subordinate clause (cannot stand alone). This contrasts with an independent clause = simple sentence (stands alone).*

■ Compound-Complex Sentence

Q16. Which sentence is an example of a compound-complex sentence? MEDIUM

A) The accounting department will conduct a detailed audit.

B) Sales were up and the staff will receive a bonus.

✔ **C) Although it will be costly at first, expansion into global markets is necessary and the firm will investigate this option.**

D) Although there was disagreement, a consensus was reached.

■ *Explanation: Option C has a dependent clause ('Although it will be costly at first') + two independent clauses ('expansion is necessary' and 'the firm will investigate') — this is compound-complex. Option A is simple, B is compound, D is complex.*

Q17. How many independent clauses must a compound-complex sentence have at minimum? MEDIUM

A) One independent clause and one dependent clause

✔ **B) Two independent clauses and at least one dependent clause**

C) Three clauses of any type

D) One independent clause with multiple dependent clauses

■ *Explanation: Compound-complex = TWO OR MORE independent clauses + AT LEAST ONE dependent clause. This is the combination of the compound structure (multiple independents) and complex structure (at least one dependent).*

Q18. In 'Employees will be moved to the fifth floor and they will share workspace BECAUSE their regular office is under renovation,' what type of sentence is this? HARD

A) Simple

B) Compound

C) Complex

✔ **D) Compound-complex**

■ *Explanation: This is compound-complex: it has two independent clauses ('Employees will be moved...' and 'they will share workspace') joined by 'and', PLUS one dependent clause ('because their regular office is under renovation') introduced by the subordinating conjunction 'because'.*

Q19. In the sample paragraph given in the slides, sentence (4) 'Even though the expansion needed to be initiated in a timely fashion, the board of directors decided to hire a consulting firm to do a feasibility study and then they intended to discuss the findings with North American affiliates' is identified as: HARD

A) Simple

B) Complex

C) Compound

✔ **D) Compound-complex**

■ *Explanation: Sentence (4) is compound-complex: it opens with the dependent clause 'Even though the expansion needed...', followed by two independent clauses joined by 'and'. The slides explicitly label it as compound-complex.*

Q20. According to the writing guidelines in the material, which of the following statements is INCORRECT advice for a writer? HARD

A) Use a variety of sentence types to create interest

B) Use long sentences to keep related information together

✔ **C) Use short sentences only — avoid long sentences entirely for clarity**

D) Introduce your paragraph with a strong topic sentence

■ *Explanation: The material advises BOTH short AND long sentences for different purposes — long sentences keep related information together, short sentences provide emphasis and relief. Avoiding long sentences entirely is incorrect advice and contradicts the material.*

■ SECTION 2: TAG QUESTIONS (Q21–Q40)

■ What Are Tag Questions?

Q21. What is the primary purpose of question tags? MEDIUM

A) To make statements more formal

✔ **B) To check whether something is true or to ask for agreement**

C) To replace question marks in writing

D) To combine two independent clauses

■ *Explanation: Per the definition: 'We use question tags to check whether something is true or to ask for agreement.' They are short questions added at the end of statements.*

Q22. Question tags come at the _____ of sentences. MEDIUM

A) beginning

B) middle

✔ **C) end**

D) anywhere in the sentence

■ *Explanation: By definition, question tags are 'small questions that come at the END of sentences.' They cannot appear at the beginning or middle.*

Q23. Which sentence correctly uses a question tag after a statement containing a NEGATIVE adverb? HARD

A) You never care for people, don't you?

✔ **B) You never care for people, do you?**

C) You never care for people, didn't you?

D) You never care for people, aren't you?

■ *Explanation: Negative adverbs (never, rarely, seldom, hardly, barely, scarcely) give a negative sense to the statement. Even though the statement looks positive, we treat it as negative and use a POSITIVE tag. So 'never' → positive tag 'do you?' (NOT 'don't you').*

■ Positive / Negative Rule

Q24. Which rule governs the positive/negative pattern in tag questions? MEDIUM

A) If the main clause is positive, the tag is also positive

B) If the main clause is negative, the tag is also negative

✔ **C) If the main clause is positive, the tag is negative; if negative, the tag is positive**

D) The tag is always negative regardless of the main clause

■ *Explanation: The fundamental rule: POSITIVE main clause → NEGATIVE tag. NEGATIVE main clause → POSITIVE tag. Example: 'It's cold, isn't it?' / 'It isn't cold, is it?'*

Q25. Choose the correct tag for: 'She isn't coming, _____?' MEDIUM

A) isn't she

✔ **B) is she**

C) wasn't she

D) does she

■ *Explanation: Main clause is NEGATIVE ('isn't coming') → tag must be POSITIVE. The auxiliary is 'is', so the tag is 'is she?' — positive and using the same auxiliary verb.*

Q26. What is the correct tag for: 'You haven't met him, _____?' MEDIUM

A) haven't you

✔ **B) have you**

C) didn't you

D) don't you

■ *Explanation: Main clause is NEGATIVE (haven't met) → tag is POSITIVE → 'have you?' The same auxiliary 'have' is used in the tag. 'Haven't you' would be a negative tag, which is wrong here.*

Q27. Which exception applies to the tag question rule for 'I am'? HARD

A) The tag for 'I am' is 'am I not'

✔ **B) The tag for 'I am' is 'aren't I' (not 'amn't I')**

C) The tag for 'I am' is 'isn't it'

D) The tag for 'I am' follows no special rule

■ *Explanation: Special exception: after 'I am', the question tag is 'AREN'T I' — not the grammatically expected 'amn't I'. Example: 'I'm in charge of the food, aren't I?'*

Q28. Select the correct tag for: 'I am not ready, _____?' HARD

A) am I not

B) aren't I

✔ **C) am I**

D) isn't I

■ *Explanation: Main clause is 'I am NOT' (negative) → tag should be POSITIVE. The positive tag for 'I am' constructions is 'am I?' — making the answer 'am I?'. Note: 'am I not' is formal written form; for 'I am NOT', the positive tag is simply 'am I?'*

■ Auxiliary Verbs Rule

Q29. If the main sentence has an auxiliary verb, the question tag: MEDIUM

A) Uses 'do/does/did' regardless

✔ **B) Repeats the same auxiliary verb**

C) Uses the opposite auxiliary verb

D) Omits the auxiliary verb entirely

■ *Explanation: Rule: If the main clause has an auxiliary verb (be, have, will, can, must, etc.), the SAME auxiliary is repeated in the tag. Example: 'They've gone away, haven't they?' — 'have' is repeated.*

Q30. If the main sentence has NO auxiliary verb (present or past simple), the tag question uses: MEDIUM

A) The verb 'be' in all cases

B) A modal verb like 'can' or 'will'

✔ **C) Do / does / did**

D) The main verb repeated

■ *Explanation: When there is no auxiliary verb in the main clause (present simple or past simple with regular verbs), we form the tag using 'do/does' (present) or 'did' (past). Example: 'You smoke, don't you?' / 'He went, didn't he?'*

Q31. Choose the correct tag for: 'John has passed the exam, _____?' (where 'has' is a non-auxiliary/main verb) HARD

A) has he

✔ **B) hasn't he**

C) doesn't he

D) didn't he

■ *Explanation: 'Has' as a non-auxiliary can take either form — but in British English, when 'has' is a main verb (not perfect auxiliary), 'hasn't he' is still standard. The correct tag here is 'hasn't he?' — negative tag after a positive main clause using the same 'has'.*

Q32. What is the correct tag for: 'He had met him before, _____?' HARD

A) has he

B) didn't he

✔ **C) hadn't he**

D) doesn't he

■ *Explanation: Main clause uses past perfect auxiliary 'had' (positive) → tag is NEGATIVE → 'hadn't he?' The same auxiliary 'had' is repeated in its negative contracted form.*

■ Modal Verbs

Q33. If a modal verb appears in the main clause, the tag question: MEDIUM

A) Always uses 'do/does/did'

✔ **B) Uses the same modal verb**

C) Uses the verb 'be'

D) Has no auxiliary — just the subject

■ *Explanation: Rule: Modal verbs (can, will, would, should, must, could, might) in the main clause are REPEATED in the tag. Example: 'They couldn't hear me, could they?' / 'You won't tell anyone, will you?'*

Q34. Choose the correct tag for: 'You won't tell anyone, _____?' MEDIUM

A) won't you

✔ **B) will you**

C) don't you

D) wouldn't you

■ *Explanation: Main clause is POSITIVE ('you won't' — note: 'won't' = will + not, so clause is NEGATIVE) → tag should be POSITIVE → 'will you?' The modal 'will' is repeated in its positive form.*

Q35. What is the correct tag for: 'John must stay, _____?' HARD

A) must he

✔ **B) mustn't he**

C) shouldn't he

D) needn't he

■ *Explanation: Main clause is POSITIVE (John must stay) → tag is NEGATIVE → 'mustn't he?' The modal 'must' is repeated in negative contracted form. This follows the same modal verb repetition rule.*

■ Imperatives & Special Cases

Q36. After a NEGATIVE imperative such as 'Don't forget,' the correct tag is: MEDIUM

A) won't you

B) would you

✔ **C) will you**

D) shall you

■ *Explanation: After NEGATIVE imperatives, we use 'will you?' as the tag. Example: 'Don't forget, will you?' For positive imperatives inviting someone, 'won't you?' is used; for instructions, 'will/would/can/could you?' is used.*

Q37. What is the correct tag for 'Let's have a party, _____?' MEDIUM

A) will we

B) won't we

✔ **C) shall we**

D) do we

■ *Explanation: After 'Let's' (let us) suggestions, the tag is always 'shall we?' — this is a fixed rule for 'let's' constructions regardless of the content of the suggestion.*

Q38. Which tag is appropriate for: 'There's something wrong, _____?' HARD

A) is there

✔ **B) isn't there**

C) isn't it

D) is it

■ *Explanation: When the subject is 'there' (existential 'there'), the tag repeats 'there' as the subject — not 'it'. Main clause is positive ('There's') → tag is negative → 'isn't there?' — not 'isn't it?'*

■ Application & Exercises

Q39. From Exercise A: 'Everybody saw you, _____?' — Choose the correct tag. HARD

A) did they

✔ **B) didn't they**

C) did everybody

D) saw they

■ *Explanation: 'Everybody' is treated grammatically as POSITIVE (affirmative). Per the rule, positive main clause → negative tag. 'Everybody' takes third-person plural 'they' in the tag, and since 'saw' is past simple with no auxiliary, we use 'did/didn't'. Answer: 'didn't they?'*

Q40. From Exercise B: 'He will never give up, _____?' — What is the correct tag? HARD

✔ **A) will he**

B) won't he

C) doesn't he

D) did he

■ *Explanation: 'Never' is a negative adverb — it gives the sentence a negative meaning even though it appears in a statement. Negative-meaning statements take POSITIVE tags. The modal 'will' is used → positive tag → 'will he?' (NOT 'won't he').*

Total: 40 MCQs | Section 1 (Types of Sentences): Q1–Q20 | Section 2 (Tag Questions): Q21–Q40
Medium: 22 Questions | Hard: 18 Questions | ✔ Correct answers highlighted in green

Prepared for: English Mids Preparation — Quizzy LMS